

1. Case Study – UPI Fraud

UPI Fraud Case Study

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is one of the most common types of cybercrime in India, especially with the increasing use of digital payments. It occurs when cybercriminals trick users into revealing sensitive information such as their UPI PIN, OTP, or bank details, leading to unauthorized transactions.

In a typical case, a scammer contacts the victim through a phone call, SMS, or social media, pretending to be a bank official, customer support agent, or even a buyer or seller. The scammer may send a fake payment request or a QR code and ask the victim to scan it or enter their UPI PIN to “receive money.” Many users are not aware that receiving money does not require entering a PIN, and they unknowingly authorize a payment instead of receiving one.

Another common method is sending phishing links that look like official banking websites. When users click these links and enter their login credentials or OTP, scammers gain access to their bank accounts and transfer money.

Victims of UPI fraud often suffer financial loss and stress. In such situations, it is very important to act quickly. The victim should immediately report the incident on the official cybercrime portal www.cybercrime.gov.in or call the helpline number **1930**. Quick reporting can help in blocking the transaction and possibly recovering the lost amount.

This case study highlights the importance of awareness and careful use of digital payment systems.

2. Prevention Checklist

Cybercrime Prevention Checklist (UPI & Online Safety)

- Never share your OTP (One-Time Password) with anyone, even if they claim to be from the bank.
- Never share your UPI PIN under any circumstances.
- Remember that to **receive money**, you do NOT need to enter your UPI PIN.

- Do not click on unknown or suspicious links received through SMS, email, or WhatsApp.
- Always verify QR codes and payment requests before scanning or accepting them.
- Use only official and trusted banking or payment applications.
- Enable two-factor authentication for all financial and important accounts.
- Regularly check your bank statements and transaction history.
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi networks for financial transactions.
- Keep your mobile phone and apps updated with the latest security updates.
- Do not install unknown apps from untrusted sources.
- Immediately report any suspicious activity to **www.cybercrime.gov.in** or call **1930**.